

# NEVERTHELESS

\* **Blue denotes PPT slide**

\* **Brown denotes instructions to technician**

**INTRO:** Today I want to talk about one word – Nevertheless.

Nevertheless:

- Can be a word bridge between fact and truth...
- Can be a connection between two ideas... (Even if the first is factual, it does not lessen the greater truth of the second)

(Use the greater than – Lesser than symbol)  
**(LEAVE SYMBOL UP UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)**

A fourth grader told his civics teacher that his dad told him that Houston is the capital

of Texas because it is the state's largest city. The teacher could not dispute the fact that the dad made the statement, or that Houston is the state's largest city, nevertheless Austin is still the capital.

By understanding this one word, we build a bridge between:

- Fact and truth...
- Opinion and truth...
- A lesser truth and greater truth...

The possibility exists that a proper understanding of this one word can:

- Kick-start our faith...
- Restore confidence...
- Usher in a resurgence of joy...
- Re-establish victorious living...

When we come to a proper understanding of this one word, we will never again be defenseless against the overpowering onslaught of hell. This word allows us to

acknowledge the challenges but focus on the Lord and His word.

*Luke 5:1-11 (KJV) “And it came to pass, that, as the people pressed upon him to hear the word of God, he stood by the lake of Gennesaret, <sup>2</sup> And saw two ships standing by the lake: but the fishermen were gone out of them, and were washing their nets. <sup>3</sup> And he entered into one of the ships, which was Simon's, and prayed him that he would thrust out a little from the land. And he sat down, and taught the people out of the ship. <sup>4</sup> Now when he had left speaking, he said unto Simon, Launch out into the deep, and let down your nets for a draught. <sup>5</sup> And Simon answering said unto him, Master, we have toiled all the night, and have taken nothing: nevertheless at thy word I will let down the net. <sup>6</sup> And when they had this done, they inclosed a great multitude of fishes: and their net brake. <sup>7</sup> And they beckoned unto*

*their partners, which were in the other ship, that they should come and help them. And they came, and filled both the ships, so that they began to sink. <sup>8</sup> When Simon Peter saw it, he fell down at Jesus' knees, saying, Depart from me; for I am a sinful man, O Lord. <sup>9</sup> For he was astonished, and all that were with him, at the draught of the fishes which they had taken: <sup>10</sup> And so was also James, and John, the sons of Zebedee, which were partners with Simon. And Jesus said unto Simon, Fear not; from henceforth thou shalt catch men. <sup>11</sup> And when they had brought their ships to land, they forsook all, and followed him.”*

In this passage of Scripture, Jesus and others were confronted with decisions. Jesus had to choose between two boats.

The decisions we make in our lives and ministries determine who we become and what we are capable of doing. There are

times when we are called upon to make decisions that will prove to be genius or detrimental.

Why did Jesus choose Peter's boat?

- He knew Peter would allow him to teach from his boat – All ministry decisions should be made based on whether or not it enhances the opportunity for teaching/preaching the Word of God.
- He knew Peter would give up control of the boat – The boat belonged to Peter, but Jesus used it as His own. This is not our church or ministry. It belongs to Jesus and we are charged with the responsibility of making sure we use it as He would please. We will account for what we did with what we had.
- He knew Peter would make Him the Captain – As owner of the boat and the fishing business, Peter was the Captain, but He quickly and willingly released that responsibility to Jesus. He called

Jesus “*Master.*”

- He knew Peter would be obedient – After teaching, Jesus tells Peter to “*Launch out into the deep and let down your nets for the draught.*” Peter basically says “*We are the professional fishermen and you are the teacher – NEVERTHELESS – at your word we will do so.*”
- He knew the miracle was only going to happen from one boat – He chose the boat whose captain and crew would take on a task in blind faith. Because of the obedience and faith of the Captain and Crew of one boat, the miracle affected the other boats. (When the water level goes up, all the boats in the harbor are raised.)

Think of this: Three of the twelve disciples (25%) were chosen to follow Jesus that day!

Can you imagine reading this passage if Peter had refused to allow Jesus to use his boat or take another stab at fishing? Can you imagine the New Testament without Peter, James and John?

When it comes to our lives, ministries and church, Satan:

- Learns his lines...
- Practices his arguments...
- Misses no opportunities...

We must stand up to his stupidity and say, nevertheless! Are we to deny facts? Never!

So, what are we to do? Once we have acknowledged the presentation of the distorted facts, we are to turn to the enemy and say, nevertheless!

**The enemy will tell us God will: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Permit prayer without answers...  
NEVERTHELESS the ear of God is tuned to the cry of the righteous!
- Work us without rewarding us...  
NEVERTHELESS He is coming and our reward is with Him!
- Send us down an unrewarding career path... NEVERTHELESS I have never seen the righteous forsaken, nor his seed begging for bread!
- Use us for His purposes and kick us to the curb... NEVERTHELESS Gods way's are above our ways!
- Allow us to pour our passions into a fruitless effort... NEVERTHELESS the path of the just is as a shining light that grows brighter each day!
- Let us take a step of faith and then pull the rug out from under us...  
NEVERTHELESS weeping may endure for a night but joy is coming in the morning!



We should not even allow the enemy to finish his sentences:

- What about all the...?  
NEVERTHELESS!
- Who will pay the...?  
NEVERTHELESS!
- What if God doesn't...?  
NEVERTHELESS!
- What if the economy...?  
NEVERTHELESS!
- This is never going to...?  
NEVERTHELESS!
- What if they don't...?  
NEVERTHELESS!
- They will never...?  
NEVERTHELESS!
- NEVERTHELESS!
- They forgot your...?  
NEVERTHELESS!

This must frustrate the beejeebees out of the devil!

## CONCLUSION:

Susan Nordin spoke this prophetic word in a recent Board meeting: *“For a God-sized future you must move off the porch of the past into the destiny God has for you.”*

**(LEAVE THESE TWO QUOTES ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE END OF THE SERVICE)**

One of our Board Members, Don Edwards commented: *“If we walk thru a door that God didn't open, with the right spirit and motives, God will still bless it.”*

2 Timothy 1:12 (NKJV) *“For this reason I also suffer these things; nevertheless I am not ashamed, for I know whom I have believed and am persuaded that He is able to keep what I have committed to Him until that Day.”*

## **PLACES PREACHED:**

CT Church – Houston TX 6/9/13

Otter Creek A/G Little Rock AR 9/13

1<sup>st</sup> A/G Van Buren AR 1/9/13

Bethel Family Worship Center Indianapolis  
IN 3/5/14

Bayshore Christian Fellowship San Leon  
TX 3/9/14